

Team SENTIENT MAVRICKS: Triumphant Journey at the India AI Impact Buildathon 2026

The Event and Organizers The India AI Impact Buildathon 2026 was a flagship national hackathon organized by the Government of India under the IndiaAI Mission and the Ministry of Electronics & Information Technology (MeitY), in collaboration with HCL GUVI. It was a core part of the India AI Impact Summit, which is recognized as the first major global Artificial Intelligence summit hosted in the Global South.

The Scale The scale of the event was massive. The initiative mobilized over 40000 participants from across India during its initial online phase. From this enormous pool of talent, only the top 2%—approximately 850 individuals grouped into 200 elite teams (divided into student and professional categories)—were selected to advance to the Grand Finale.

What We Built (In Simple Terms) Our team engineered the "AI Call Shield," a real-time defense system designed to combat the rising threat of deepfake audio and AI voice cloning. Scammers frequently use synthetic voices to impersonate trusted individuals or officials to steal sensitive information like OTPs and UPI PINs.

Our application acts as a protective layer during phone calls. As a call happens, our AI instantly analyzes the physics of the voice, looking for unnatural pitch stability, robotic acoustic patterns, and "perfect silence"—tell-tale signs of a machine-generated voice. It also monitors the conversation for high-pressure, manipulative language typically used by fraudsters across multiple regional languages. Crucially, the system does all of this while automatically hiding personal data (like account numbers) to ensure complete user privacy.

Our Journey from Start to End

- **Phase 1 (January 2026):** We entered the online round, which required us to pass a rigorous evaluation of our AI foundations and the core architecture of our project.
- **Phase 2 (The Call-Up):** We successfully placed in the top 200 teams, securing an invitation to the physical Grand Finale at the prestigious Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi on February 16, 2026.
- **Phase 3 (The 30-Minute Crucible):** At the live event, we didn't just present our pre-written code; we had to survive a highly pressurized 30-minute technical evaluation where we were forced to enhance and modify our project live on the spot. We successfully proved our system's robustness and advanced to the final Top 6 teams.
- **Phase 4 (The Executive Pitch):** We pitched our completed "AI Call Shield" to a panel of top-tier industry executives and tech leaders, including Neeraj Walia (EZSnippet), Dr. Chandrasekhar Buddha (Chief Coordinating Officer, AICTE), Ankit Kakkar (Senior Director at MongoDB), Sandeep Saini (Senior VP at HCLTech), and Balamurugan SP

(Co-Founder of GUVI).

- **The Result:** Team SENTIENT MAVRICKS proudly secured the **3rd Place** in the Student Category, taking home a cash prize of ₹40,000 and bringing immense pride to our institution.

- These are the official links of the linkin post

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Our Photos folder

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